Using parentheses is one of the most common ways accountants increase the readability of a **negative** number in their reports.



	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	**Category A**	**Stock**	**Purchase Price**	**Selling Price**	**Profit or Loss**	
2	Beverages	2,000	$250.00	$300.00	$50.00	
3	Beverages	3,000	$300.00	$280.00	-$20.00	
4	Condiments	4,000	$350.00	$420.00	$70.00	
5						

To express the negative values in a standard way, you can put parentheses around them.

The "**Negative numbers**" list allows you to select a format from a list of format options if you wish to format negative numbers differently by choosing the list.